

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 973

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor the Gatlinburg-Pittman Junior High School Lady Highlanders basketball team upon winning the TMSAA Class AA state championship.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of young ladies is the Lady Highlanders basketball team of Gatlinburg-Pittman Junior High School, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by winning the 2025-2026 TMSAA Class AA state championship; and

WHEREAS, before claiming the title of state champion, the Lady Highlanders defeated Alcoa for the district championship, Meigs County for the regional championship, and West Greene Middle in the sectional title game to earn a state tournament berth; and

WHEREAS, in the semifinals, the young women from Gatlinburg-Pittman flew past Prescott South Middle by a score of 42-22 to set up a battle for the state crown with E.O. Coffman, from which they emerged triumphant after a hard fought 25-18 victory; and

WHEREAS, the Lady Highlanders finished the season with a record of 30-3, winning the state championship on a 15-game winning streak; and

WHEREAS, Gatlinburg-Pittman's Coach Alex Bowers displayed strategic leadership and a crucial ability to adapt to every challenge, ultimately leading the Lady Highlanders to the state championship; and

WHEREAS, the Lady Highlanders were fortunate to enjoy the unfailing support of their families, fans, fellow students, and the entire community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Gatlinburg-Pittman Junior High School girls' basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Gatlinburg-Pittman Junior High School Lady Highlanders for their outstanding season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the coaches and players of the Gatlinburg-Pittman Junior High School Lady Highlanders basketball team upon winning the 2025-2026 TMSAA Class AA state championship and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.